6.13 Search (Lab 6.1)

LAB ACTIVITY | 6.13.1: Search (Lab 6.1) | Full screen | 0 / 30

Searching a list is such a common computational task that many languages (including Python) include a means to perform this operation. However, it is also a great opportunity to practice selection, repetition and functions, so today we will create our own version.

Download this template and rename it `search.py`:

- template.py

Write a linear search function named `search` that searches for a target in a list of elements, returning the position of the first occurrence of the target in the list. If it doesn't find the target, it returns -1. Here is the algorithm:

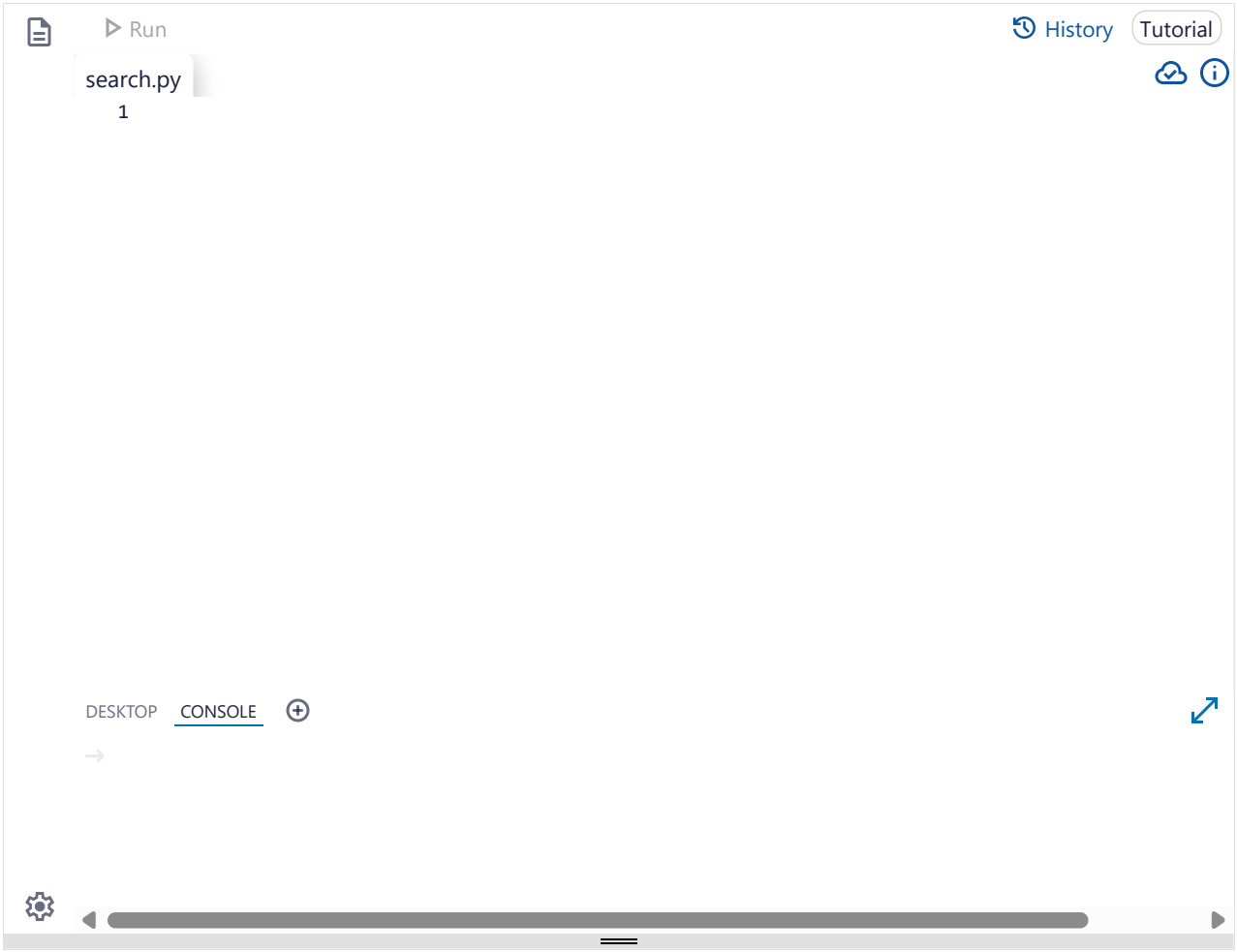
1. **Given:** a list to search, called `str_list`, and a target to find, called `target`
2. **Repeat** for `i` in all indexes for `str_list` (i.e., from 0 through list length - 1):
    1. **If** `target` is the same as the current element in the list then
        1. **Return** `i`.
3. **Return** -1.

Implement these test cases using `assert`:

function invocation	return value
`search(['this', 'is', 'the', 'day'], 'is')`	`1`
`search(['this', 'is', 'the', 'day'], 'that')`	`-1`
`search([], 'this')`	`-1`

Notice that this algorithm appropriately returns -1 for an empty list as well as when the target word is not present.

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